YIFEI SUN

Principal Software Engineer · GenAI Automation & Backend Platform Architecture · 13 Years

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Airbnb Hiring Team
Staff GenAI Backend Engineer, Automation Foundation

Dear Airbnb Hiring Team,

I've been an Airbnb guest many times and understand firsthand how much the support experience matters when something goes wrong mid-trip. The idea of building the conversational AI platform behind that experience — at Airbnb's scale, for millions of guests and hosts — is what drew me to this role.

I bring direct production experience on both sides of this job. On the AI side, I built an MCP server for conversational AI tool calling on the OpenAI Apps SDK, and separately built a GenAI automation platform with RAG-augmented inference, prompt optimization, and an evaluation harness with hallucination detection. On the backend side, I have 13 years of distributed systems experience — including leading a platform modernization across 10+ teams that cut p99 latency 5x and hit 99.9% availability. At a previous company, I partnered directly with support and operations teams to modernize customer-facing workflows.

What excites me most is that this is an existing, widely adopted platform — not a greenfield experiment. Evolving a large-scale production system while improving AI quality, prompt effectiveness, and agent planning is harder than building from scratch, and it's where I do my best work. I'd love to discuss how I can help the Automation Foundation team deliver better support experiences through AI.

Sincerely,

Yifei Sun